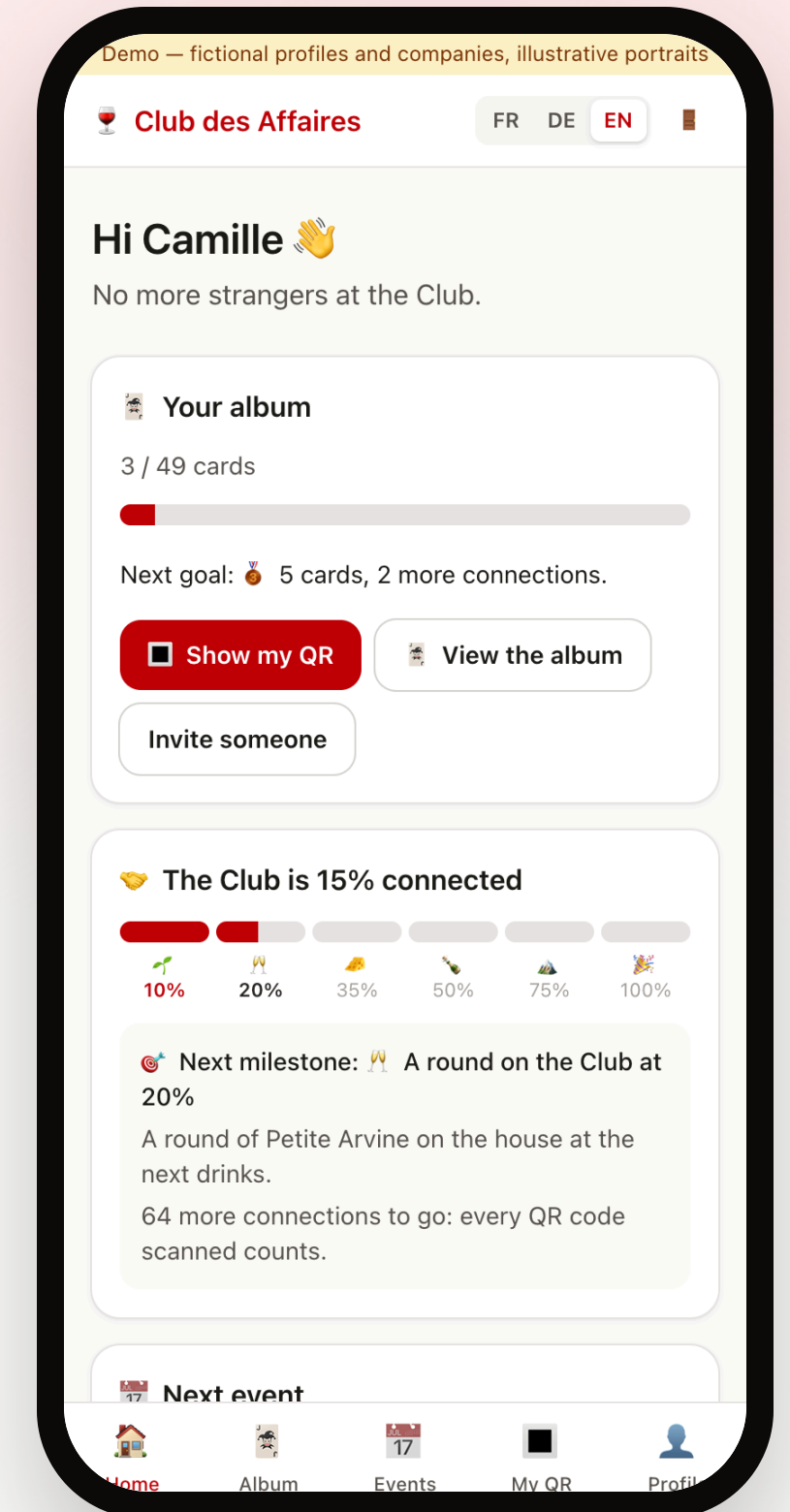


HACK VS · CHALLENGE FOIRE DU VALAIS

Never a stranger at the Club again.

A year-round networking platform for the members of the Club des Affaires de la Foire du Valais.

Live demo · public on GitHub · FR / DE / EN



THE CHALLENGE

The network only lives on event nights.

≈ 50

business leaders

500

CHF a year, per member

4–5

evenings a year

80 %

attendance... among strangers

What we observed

Members come, but arrive as strangers and stay in small groups.
Between two evenings, communication only goes one way: from the Foire to them.

What the client asked for

No forced selling: business is a door, not the core · a small team with little time · French and German speakers · premium means the people and the evenings · the member list stays private.

THE SOLUTION

One app that follows the rhythm of the Club.

FIND



Member cards

Sector, passions, pet peeves, what you can help with and what you look for. An album for members only.

SYNERGIES



Your 3 introductions

Before each evening: three people to meet and why: shared passions, complementary sectors, a need the other can meet.

COLLABORATE



Meet for real

Scan a badge: the card joins your album, contact details unlock. People bingo at drinks, rotating tables at dinner.

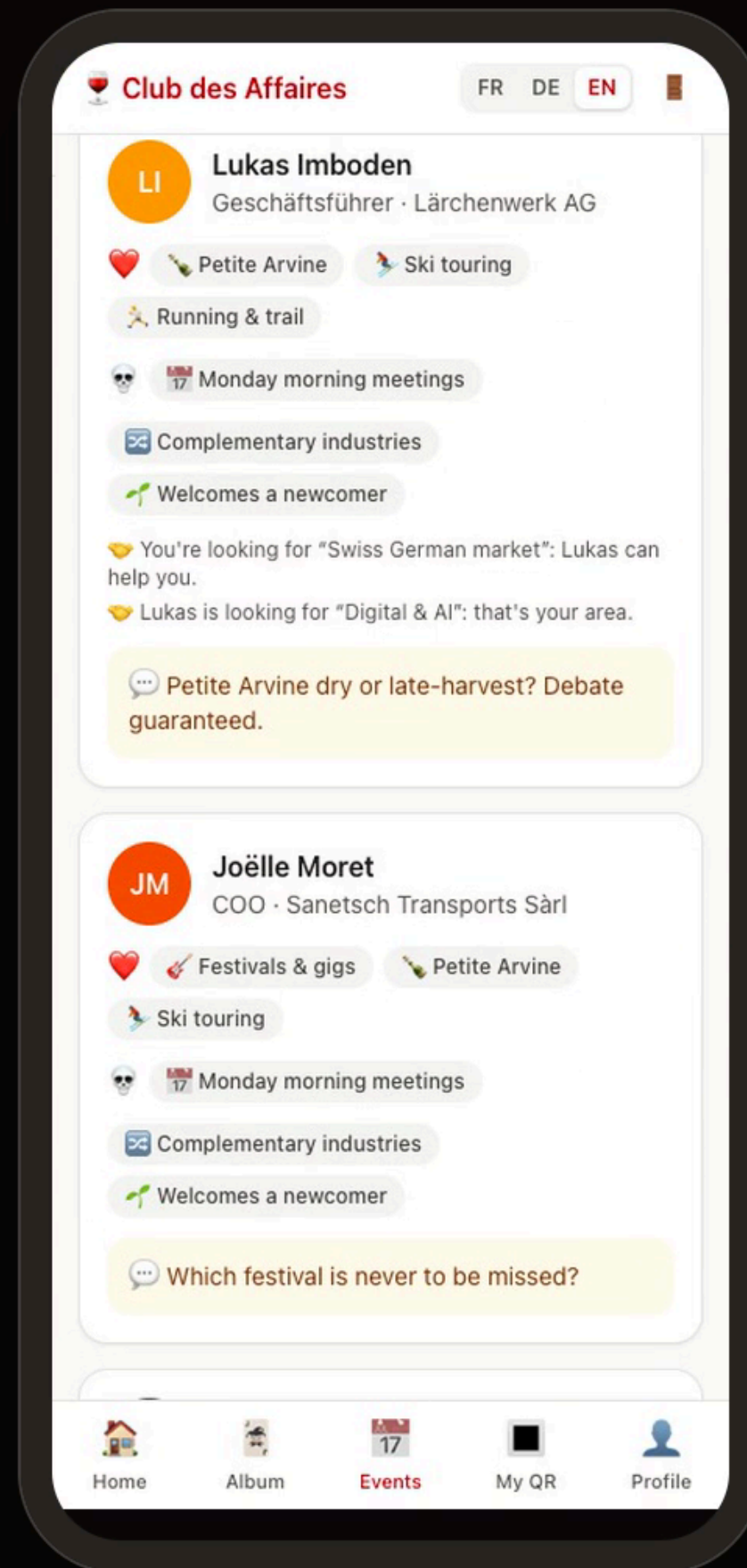
BELONG



A club that grows closer

Shared milestones with Valais rewards, a monthly digest of new members, invitations by referral.

DEMO · 40 SECONDS



BEFORE THE EVENING

She already knows who to meet

Lukas shares her love of Petite Arvine, and they can help each other: digital for him, the Swiss German market for her.

WHAT IS NEW

Every real encounter counts — and is counted.



A collectible album

A QR scan is the proof you really met: only then do contact details unlock. No cold messages, no spam.



15 % connected → shared milestones

The share of member pairs who know each other. At 20 %, a round of Petite Arvine; at 35 %, a raclette; at 100 %, “never a stranger”.



A bingo computed for each guest

Only people present tonight, nudging you to strangers and to your 3 introductions; a full card is always possible (bipartite matching).



Rotating tables that really mix

38 guests, 3 courses: about 250 new pairs, a single repeat. A Social Golfer heuristic, computed in under a second.

FEASIBILITY & IMPACT

It works today.

- **Django 5.2 LTS**, server-rendered, PostgreSQL: one framework, few moving parts
- **Secure by default**: closed to visitors, strict CSP, tested access matrix, contacts only after a real meeting
- **400 automated tests**, every page checked in FR / DE / EN on phone and desktop
- **For a small team**: create the event, tick an activity, click “Prepare”. Accept a member: one click
- **< CHF 500 a year** to run · 6–8 days to production, within the CHF 10k budget

“A club that knows itself comes back together.”

Next: from 50 to 100 members through referrals, then the same platform for other clubs and fairs.

Boring technology, on purpose.

Members & staff

Phone or computer browser · nothing to install · a QR code opens the right page · FR / DE / EN

Django 5.2 LTS · gunicorn

Member area · staff tools · Django admin (back office) · public showcase
services/: matching · rotating tables · bingo · federation index & milestones · notifications & digest — pure Python, unit-tested

Data & delivery

PostgreSQL (SQLite in dev) · SMTP for e-mails · static files served by the app (no CDN, no tracker) · Swiss hosting for production

CHOICE	WHY
Web app, not native	Nothing to install for 50 busy people; one code base instead of three
Server-rendered templates	No API to expose and secure, light pages on mobile, strict CSP possible
Django admin	A complete, secure back office from day one, in the staff's language

Three small algorithms, measured.

WHAT	HOW	MEASURED
Your 3 introductions	Pair score: +3 shared passion, +2 shared pet peeve, +2 different sectors, +3 newcomer with a pillar, + a bonus when one can meet the other's need. Never two people who already know each other, never without a common language. Fair greedy rounds.	200 guests: 49 ms
Rotating tables	Social Golfer problem (NP-hard): local search with restarts; penalties for sitting together again, no common language, already acquainted, same sector.	200 guests: 0.8 s
People bingo	Per-player grid from tonight's guests only; priority to strangers and to your introductions; a full card stays possible (bipartite matching, augmenting paths); a scan ticks the rarest square.	49 tests
Federation index	Density of the “who met whom” graph = connections ÷ member pairs; drives the Club milestones and lists isolated members for the staff.	demo: 15 %

Closed by default.

Application security

Login required everywhere (middleware) · tested access matrix: a new route must be classified or the suite fails · CSRF on every form · strict CSP, no inline script or style · QR codes carry 128-bit random tokens · single-use login links (15 min) · HTTPS, HSTS, secure cookies.

Data protection (Swiss nLPD)

Directory visible to members only · contact details shared only after a real meeting · any member can hide their card · private notes visible to their author only · photos served privately · minimal data · production hosted in Switzerland.

No ads. Invitations.

CHANNEL	HOW
Referral (n°1)	Each member has a personal link and QR code; an optional referral discount, to be validated by the committee
Discovery guest	At the Christmas drinks, each member may bring one person: an evening sells better than a brochure
Substitutes	A member who cannot come sends a colleague, who receives the evening's details and an invitation
Foire exhibitors	20–30 hand-picked exhibitors invited by letter; members invite one exhibitor to the Wow evening
Upper Valais	German-speaking ambassadors; one drinks evening a year hosted by a member in the Upper Valais

Goal: 15–20 new members a year, at most 5 newcomers per evening, more than 60 % via referral.

Within budget, ready to grow.

Cost

Swiss hosting, database, e-mails and domain: under CHF 500 a year, less than 2 % of the fees. From this prototype to production: about 6 to 8 days (Swiss hosting, e-mail sending, branding, member import, two-factor login for the staff, privacy policy), within the CHF 10,000 envelope.

Roadmap

V1.1 production in Switzerland, member import, privacy self-service.
V2 “I'm looking for / I offer” board, co-development groups, membership payment (TWINT, QR-bill). **V3** the same platform for other clubs and fairs (white label).